

fall out of their reasonable parity with other securities on such occasions, than by attempts at wholesale shifts into and out of equities as a whole. One must not allow one's attitude to securities which have a daily market quotation to be disturbed by this fact.

If these ideas were good enough for the Great Depression, they're good enough for whatever comes next now.

Floyd Odlum: Making the Best of Bad Times

Floyd Odlum is sometimes described as the only guy to make a fortune in the Great Depression. (He wasn't.)

James Grant, editor of *Grant's Interest Rate Observer*, called Odlum a

"salvage artist par excellence." "None of us can know the future," Grant wrote. "But, like Odlum, we can make the best of a sometimes unappetizing present."

Grant also managed to scrounge up a pretty good anecdote on Odlum.

In the summer of 1933, when all the world seemed to be in pieces, Odlum strolled into his office, looked at his glum partners and said, "I believe there's a better chance to make money now than ever before."

Odlum liked poking around in the smoking wreckage of the 1930s.

Bad times create wonderful pricing. The story of a man with the odd name of Odlum is one of how he got rich in the Great Depression.

Floyd Bostwick Odlum was a lawyer and industrialist, born in 1892.

He started his investing career in 1923 with \$39,000. In a couple of years, he turned that into \$700,000 through some savvy investing in deeply undervalued stocks and other securities. Odlum was on his way. All told, in about 15 years he parlayed that \$39,000 into over \$100 million.

His big score came after the crash of 1929. Odlum bought busted-up investment trusts. As Diana Henriques writes in *The White Sharks of Wall Street*, "Odlum [became] a multimillionaire almost overnight by investing in the undervalued shares of twenty-two investment trusts decimated by the 1929 crash."